

Port

It is a virtual point where the network connection starts and ends.

It is software-based and managed by the OS

Each port is associated with a specific process or service.

Port Number

It is a logical communication endpoint used by computers to identify which application or service should receive network traffic.

IP address = the building

Port Number = the room number inside the building

Common Port Numbers

Port	Purpose
20/21	FTP file transfer
22	SSH remote login
25	Email (SMTP)
53	DNS
80	HTTP websites
443	HTTPS secure websites
3306	MySQL database
5432	PostgreSQL

Why does it matter?

- Run multiple services on one computer

- Organize network traffic
- Secure systems using firewalls
- Allow apps to communicate correctly

Example:

- a firewall may allow port 443 but block port 22
- a developer may expose port 8080 for testing